

Σόλωνος Ἐπιστολαί

Tyranny in the Solon Letters

eul_aid: anm

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)

Dialect: Ἀττική [Attic](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Ἐπιστολή [Epistle](#)

The Solon Letters are a collection of eleven epistles spuriously attributed to the Athenian statesman and poet Solon, who lived circa 630–560 BCE. The historical Solon was an Archaic-period lawmaker, one of the Seven Sages, credited with foundational democratic reforms in Athens in 594/3 BCE. The letters are a later literary fabrication, likely from the Hellenistic or Roman period, which adopt Solon's persona to discuss his reforms, travels, and philosophy. Their actual author is unknown.

The corpus consists solely of these Epistles, preserved within the larger pseudepigraphical tradition of letters attributed to famous Greek figures.

The collection is significant as an example of pseudepigraphical literature, illustrating the later reception and idealization of Solon. While providing no reliable historical data about sixth-century Athens, the letters are valuable for understanding how later antiquity constructed the legacy of early lawgivers and sages. They testify to Solon's enduring symbolic status as a wise statesman and political thinker.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Τυραννίδος · [Fragments on Tyranny](#) · 4 passages